

*each hair is hollow,
and air trapped inside the
bear's coat enhances both
insulation and buoyancy*

*fur is colourless, and
reflects white light*

^ MIGHTY BEAR

The largest polar bears weigh as much as 800 kg (1,760 lb), but much of their apparent bulk is due to their immensely thick fur. They are able to run in short bursts at speeds of up to 40 km (25 miles) per hour. They are an impressive sight, but there are fewer than 20,000–25,000 polar bears left in the wild, and their numbers are declining due to climate change.

*the huge, forepaws make effective paddles
when swimming, propelling the bear at
around 6 kph (4 mph) for hours at a time*

*hind paws act
as rudders when
swimming*

